

TrustMRR

Decoding 1,000 Indie Startups

Insights into revenue, growth, and category dynamics derived from the TrustMRR startup dataset.

Dataset frozen 30 Jul 2026 ▪ 1,000 startups ▪ 29 fields

Dataset Overview

What TrustMRR tracks, and the shape of the sample

TrustMRR lists real, revenue-verified indie and small SaaS startups. Each record captures:

- Revenue & MRR** — 30-day, 3-month, 12-month, all-time, plus growth %
- Traction** — active subscriptions, X followers, domain rating
- Positioning** — category, audience type, pricing model, persona
- Marketplace status** — whether for sale, asking price, revenue multiple

1,000
29
26.2%

startups tracked
data fields
listed for sale

19.7%
50+
29

report \$0 MRR
countries
categories

A wide, messy, real-world dataset — heavy skew and missing fields are part of the story, not noise to ignore.

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A Few Giants, a Long Tail

MRR is heavily right-skewed — mean is not a fair summary

Why it matters

- Mean MRR (\$13,472) is ~48x the median (\$282) — a handful of outliers (Stan, Brand On Demand) pull the average far above what a typical startup earns.
- 19.7% of startups report exactly \$0 MRR.
- 21.6% report \$0 in 30-day revenue.
- Median active subscriptions is just 16, vs. a mean of 501.
- Takeaway: report the median as the 'typical' startup, and use the mean only to describe total market value.

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Category Volume vs. Category Value

AI dominates by headcount — but not by average revenue

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The US Leads on Both Volume and Value

Top 6 countries by startup count, and their average MRR

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B2B Startups Out-Earn B2C

Median and average MRR by audience type

255

B2B startups — median MRR \$1,036

401

B2C startups — median MRR \$181

56

Serve both — median MRR \$352

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The Acquisition Marketplace

1 in 4 startups is listed for sale — and sellers skew mid-size, not top-of-market

262
\$35K

On sale vs. not for sale (MRR)

~3.9x

Median MRR — on sale: \$1,055

Median MRR — not for sale: \$187

Mean MRR — on sale: \$7,809

Mean MRR — not for sale: \$15,482

startups on sale (26.2%)

median asking price

median revenue multiple

Top asking prices: 1Lookup (\$10M), Project A (\$5M), POST BRIDGE (\$4.2M) — all with MRR in the \$30K–\$210K range.

The biggest whales (Stan, Brand On Demand) aren't for sale — listings cluster in the established-but-not-massive range.

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Key Takeaways

01

Skew, not scale

02

Volume $\neq$ value

Median MRR (\$282) tells the real story of a typical startup — the mean is dominated by a handful of outliers.

AI has 3x more startups than any category, but E-comm and Analytics earn more per company on average.

03

Geography compounds

04

B2B pays more

The US leads on both count and average MRR — success isn't evenly spread globally.

Median B2B MRR (\$1,036) is nearly 6x median B2C MRR (\$181).

05

Followers $\neq$ revenue

06

Sellers are mid-market

X follower count barely correlates with MRR ($r \approx 0.02$) — audience size isn't a reliable revenue signal.

Startups for sale skew toward established-but-not-massive MRR — the true top performers aren't listed.

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